

GAMERS ARE SOCIAL ANIMALS



Over the years, gamers have been generalised and portrayed as brooding, introverted geeks, so much so that some might say there's a social stigma attached to being a gamer. We play mythbusters and hope to dispel the veil of misinformation that surrounds this subject

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Most people seem to think of gamers as dark, anti-social beings. Nothing could be further from the truth. Gaming is a highly social activity, what with the extensive number of gamers who meet, interact and develop friendships using gaming as a vehicle.

Online multiplayer gaming is the Facebook of gaming networks. Even while seated in their rooms, gamers can meet other gamers from all over the world by taking their games online.



Most games and multiplayer platforms such as Xbox Live, PlayStation Network and Steam also allow you to add others to your friends lists and play with them frequently. And then you have online clans, wherein fraggers team up frequently in

an effort to rise up clan rankings. As more and more games feature co-operative game modes, more and more gamers are teaming up in an effort to experience these modes. So much so that game sales are being influenced most significantly by the strength of their multiplayer component, rather than by the single-player campaign.

This escalates when the topic of Massively Multiplayer Online Games



comes up. These games feature persistent online worlds where players compete with, or support each other. Players band together to attempt quests and clear missions in MMORPGs, thus heightening their social activity



and usually moving their relationships to the next phase, viz the offline world. Take Tamara Langman and John Bentley, for example, who met each other when logged into *World of Warcraft* and eventually ended up getting married.

World of Warcraft and *Runescape* are the most popular MMORPGs, with the former holding a 11+ million paying subscriber base, despite using a pay-per-month model. *Runescape*, which is free to play, has over 156 million registered accounts. These numbers immediately tell you that tons of people out there like playing games that are purely multiplayer.